FJ 10310/19

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FROM TOKYO TO FOREIGN OFFICE

Cypher/OTP

FOREIGN OFFICE AND
WHITEHALL DISTRIBUTION

Sir E. Dening
No. 92
19th January 1952

D: 8.08 a.m. 20th January 1952
R: 9.00 a.m. 20th January 1952

JAN

PRIORITY
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Addressed to Foreign Office telegram No. 92 of 19th January
Repeated for information to Washington
and Saving to Singapore (FJ10310)

Your telegram No. 54 of 18th January: Sino-Japanese Relations.

There have been persistent stories in Tokyo that Yoshida's letter to Mr. Dulles followed an Angle-American agreement on the issue in Washington. Moreover the acting Head of the New Zealand Liaison Mission saw the Japanese Vice Minister for Foreign Affairs on January 18th and alleges that Mr. Iguchi told him that Mr. Acheson handed you a copy of the letter of December 24th while you were in Washington.

2. New Zealand representative is not always a very reliable reporter but as on this occasion he repeated the same story to more than one person, the Minister took the opportunity of calling on the Vice Minister on other matters, to refer to current stories that Yoshida's letter was the result of Anglo-American agreement, and to express the hope that nothing that had been said by any member of this mission had given this impression. This elicited from Mr. Iguchi the fact that the Secretary General of the Liberal Party's reference to such agreement (my telegram No. 79) had been based on press reports from Washington and that the Ministry of Foreign Affairs did not pretend to have any official knowledge of such agreement. Any statements attributed to Japanese Ministry of Foreign Affairs spokesmen to the effect that such agreement was believed to exist were based similarly on press reports. Minister made suitable comment.

(FJ10310)

3. Statement issued in London should put an end to these stories.

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